

Present Perfect Continuous

CEFR B1

Lesson Pack · summary, worksheet & answer key

Quick answer

The present perfect continuous (have/has been + verb-ing) links a past action to now, focusing on duration. Use it for:

- 1 How long an action has been happening — I've been studying for two hours.
- 2 A recent activity with a visible result now — You're tired because you've been running.

Use for/since for duration. For a finished result or a quantity, use the present perfect instead (I've read three books).

At a glance

Form	Structure	Example
Affirmative	subject + have/has + been + verb- ing	She has been working .
Negative	subject + haven't/hasn't + been + verb-ing	They haven't been sleeping .
Question	Have/Has + subject + been + verb-ing?	Have you been waiting?

Learning objectives

- Can form the present perfect continuous with have/has + been + -ing (CEFR B1).
- Can use it for duration up to now and for a recent activity with a present result.
- Can distinguish it from the present perfect simple and avoid it with stative verbs.



Practice worksheet

Circle the correct option. Present Perfect Continuous · CEFR B1

Name: _____

Date: _____

1. I'm exhausted because I ____ all day.

- A. worked
- C. work

- B. have been working
- D. am working

2. How long ____ you ____ English?

- A. have / been learning
- C. are / learning

- B. did / learn
- D. have / learned

3. Your hands are filthy! What ____ you ____?

- A. have / been doing
- C. are / doing

- B. did / do
- D. have / done

4. I ____ three cups of coffee today.

- A. 've been drinking
- C. drink

- B. 've drunk
- D. drank

5. We ____ each other since university.

- A. 've been knowing
- C. know

- B. 've known
- D. knew

6. He ____ five kilometres today — that's why he's tired.

- A. 's been running
- C. runs

- B. 's run
- D. ran

7. We ____ waiting for ages!

- A. have
- C. are

- B. have been
- D. has been

8. They ____ sleeping well lately.

- A. haven't been
- C. didn't

- B. hasn't been
- D. aren't

9. Rewrite with the same meaning: 'She started painting three hours ago and she's still painting.'

- A. She painted for three hours.
- C. She's painted three pictures.

- B. She's been painting for three hours.
- D. She paints for three hours.

10. The ground is wet — it ____.

- A. has been raining
- C. rains

- B. rained
- D. is raining

Answer key

Correct answers with explanations · for the teacher

1. **B. have been working** — A recent activity explaining a result now takes the present perfect continuous: 'have been working'.
2. **A. have / been learning** — 'How long' + an ongoing activity takes the present perfect continuous: 'have you been learning'.
3. **A. have / been doing** — A recent activity with a visible result now takes the continuous: 'have you been doing'.
4. **B. 've drunk** — For a completed quantity (three cups), use the present perfect simple: 'have drunk'.
5. **B. 've known** — State verbs like 'know' take the present perfect simple: 'have known'.
6. **B. 's run** — A completed quantity (five km) takes the present perfect simple: 'has run'.
7. **B. have been** — Present perfect continuous with 'we' = 'have been' + -ing: 'have been waiting'.
8. **A. haven't been** — Negative present perfect continuous with 'they' = 'haven't been' + -ing.
9. **B. She's been painting for three hours.** — An action that started in the past and continues, focusing on duration, takes the present perfect continuous.
10. **A. has been raining** — A recent activity explaining the result now (wet ground) takes the continuous: 'has been raining'.